

DECOR / GARDEN / TRAVEL

HBD
HOME BY DESIGN®

2022

attention to detail

LAYERS THAT INSPIRE





attention to detail

We love the little things. Looking at examples of stunning interior design day in and day out never gets old, but it is details such as a vintage mantel, a wall covering with texture, or a piece of artwork over a bathtub that keeps us hooked.

In this issue, we pay attention to detail. Each of the four featured designs are brought to life with a collection of details that are anything but builder-grade basic. In our lifestyle department, we take a look at life beyond a renovation with estate planning. Because you can never be too prepared, we've rounded up ten flowering trees in our garden department so you can plan for shade and look forward to blooms. Crabapple made the list, while we recommend Gala or Fuji for our apple and prosciutto crostini with whipped blue cheese recipe. The easy appetizer is part of this issue's sweet and savory menu with dishes designed to satiate. It would be a challenge to walk away hungry from a trip to Prague, Czech Republic. Our featured destination—known as the City of Spires—is renowned for hearty fare and Baroque and Gothic architecture with detail for days.

As always, thank you for your business, support, and friendship. If you are ever in need of professional assistance and advice, please do not hesitate to call. You can be assured that your needs will be met with the utmost integrity and professionalism. 

Clean Slate.

If choosing paint colors makes you dizzy, keep it simple and focus on introducing thoughtful details with texture and finishes. For walls, turn to the aptly named Decorator's White by Benjamin Moore, the backdrop for one of this issue's design features.

**“In the end,
we all become stories.”**

—Margaret Atwood

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HOME BY DESIGN®

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amber waves

A COLOR PALETTE OF RICH EARTH TONES AND METALLICS



Suspend Chair: Brass metal frame and velvet makes for modern luxe / www.kardiel.com

Geometric Gold Velvet Pillow: Handmade cover from gorgeous designer fabric / www.chairish.com

Hans Pedestal Table: Minimalist shape rendered in solid cast polished brass / www.jonathanadler.com



Ripple Pendant: Large and twinkly pendant, sized perfectly for over a table / www.jonathanadler.com

Head for the Hills by Jess Frank: Earthy art print that glows / www.minted.com

Vista Alegre Bicos Old Fashioned Glass: Durable and richly textured drinking glass / www.williams-sonoma.com

Vista Alegre Bicos Wine Decanter: Handcrafted in Portugal using century-old, pressed-glass techniques / www.williams-sonoma.com



sweet & savory

PERFECTLY PAIRED AND BALANCED DISHES

RECIPES AND PHOTOGRAPHS BY KRISTEL MATOUSEK
WWW.PHOTORICALFOOD.COM

Although we enjoy the pleasures of savory foods, we often crave sweets. So why not indulge in both flavor profiles in a single bite? I've taken the guesswork out of it and whipped up a few great sweet-and-savory combinations so you don't have to choose. Explore pairings of bacon and maple syrup, apple and prosciutto, BBQ Chicken and horseradish cream, sweet potatoes and chorizo sausage, thyme and blackberries. Here, you'll find several perfectly paired and balanced combinations that you crave, with recipes that highlight them.



apple & prosciutto crostini with whipped blue cheese

Makes 18

Crostini

1 rustic French baguette sliced
Olive oil, as needed
½ gala or fuji apple,
thinly sliced
3 ounces (9 slices)
prosciutto, sliced
Sides of arugula and honey,
for serving

Whipped Blue Cheese

8 ounces cream cheese
4 ounces blue cheese crumbles
¼ cup half-and-half
2 tablespoons olive oil
Milk, as needed to
adjust consistency
Salt to your tastes

Preheat the oven to 350 degrees F.

Lightly brush one side of the baguette slices with oil and place them oil-side down on a parchment-lined baking sheet. Bake until the bread begins to brown, approximately 5 to 7 minutes. Remove from the oven and let cool fully.

In a mixing bowl, cream together the cream cheese and blue cheese crumbles with the half-and-half and oil using a hand or stand mixer. Some small blue

cheese lumps may remain. If too thick or not fluffy enough, adjust consistency with milk as needed. Taste and season with salt if necessary.

Spread a spoonful of the whipped blue cheese on the oiled side of the toasted bread. Top with 2 slices of apple and 2 slices of prosciutto. Serve with sides of honey and arugula to allow guests to serve themselves.



twice-baked sweet potatoes

Serves 4

2 pounds sweet potatoes
Oil, as needed
Salt to your tastes
½ pound chorizo
(seasoned ground pork)
2 teaspoons butter, melted
¼ cup sour cream,
additional for topping
2 ounces Monterey
jack cheese, grated
2 tablespoons
chopped cilantro

Preheat the oven to 350 degrees F.

Cut the sweet potatoes in half lengthways, brush the cut side with oil, season with salt, and place them cut-side down on a parchment-lined baking sheet. Bake for 30 minutes or until soft when punctured with a fork. Remove from the oven and let cool to the touch.

Preheat a skillet over medium heat. Fully cook the chorizo, then remove from heat and set aside.

Scoop the potato out of the skin with a spoon, leaving a little bit of the potato in the skin so it holds its shape. Collect the potato in a medium-sized bowl as you scoop it out and retain the skin for later use. Combine the potato with the butter and ¼ cup sour cream, taste and season with salt if needed, then spoon the mixture back into the hollowed-out skins.

Top with cheese and cooked chorizo. Place the potatoes back into the oven and bake until the cheese is melted. Top with fresh chopped cilantro and serve warm with additional sour cream.



chicken meatballs & horseradish cream

Makes 50 meatballs

Meatballs

2 pounds chicken thighs,
large diced
½ onion (2 ounces),
small diced
4 cloves garlic, minced
2 teaspoons salt
½ teaspoon pepper
½ cup bread crumbs
2 eggs
2 tablespoons parsley
2 tablespoons oil
BBQ sauce, to coat

Horseradish Cream

½ cup mayonnaise
½ cup sour cream
1 tablespoon prepared
horseradish
Salt, to your tastes

Place diced chicken into a food processor and pulse to finely grind the chicken. Add the remaining ingredients (except the oil and BBQ sauce), pulsing until combined.

Uniformly divide the mixture and shape into balls.

Preheat a skillet over medium-high heat, then add the oil. Gently place the preformed balls into the oil and brown on all sides.

Drain off excess oil from the pan. Pour BBQ sauce over the meatballs, tossing them in the sauce. Return the pan to heat and simmer them in the sauce to finish and thicken slightly. (Alternately, bake in

a 350 degree F oven until golden brown on all sides, toss in BBQ sauce, and return to the oven to finish and thicken.)

For the dipping sauce, combine all the ingredients. Season with salt to your tastes, and serve alongside the meatballs.



BBQ sauce

Makes 1 prepared cup

3 tablespoons oil
1 yellow onion (4 ounces),
small diced
Habanero pepper, small diced
4 cloves garlic, minced
½ teaspoon ground
mustard powder
1 teaspoon sweet paprika
½ teaspoon black pepper
6 ounces pineapple juice
¼ cup apple cider vinegar
¼ cup molasses
¼ cup water
3 tablespoons
Worcestershire sauce
1½ cups tomato sauce
Salt, as needed

Preheat a medium-sized sauce pot over medium heat, then add the oil. Sweat the onions and habanero pepper until soft and begin to brown.

Add the garlic, mustard, paprika, and pepper to the pan, then cook 20 to 30 seconds, or until aromatic.

Deglaze the pan with pineapple juice, and add the remaining ingredients, stirring to combine. Bring to a boil, then reduce to a simmer for 20 minutes. Cook to thicken, stirring occasionally to prevent scorching.

Remove from heat and let cool. Taste and adjust seasoning as needed.

TIP:
If desired, use an
immersion blender
for a smoother
consistency.



bacon cinnamon rolls with maple frosting

Serves 10

Cinnamon Rolls

1 cup milk (8 fluid ounces),
68 to 80 degrees F
2¼ teaspoons (9 grams)
active dry yeast
2 eggs, beaten and at
room temperature
¼ cup (2 ounces) melted butter
3¾ cups (490 grams) flour
¼ cup (55 grams) sugar
¾ teaspoon (5 grams) salt
¼ cup (2 ounces) butter,
softened
1 cup brown sugar
1 teaspoon cinnamon
½ cup (2 ounces)
cooked bacon bits

Maple Frosting

1 cup (8 ounces) butter,
softened
3¾ cups (371 grams)
powdered sugar
¼ cup (2 fluid ounces) milk
¼ cup (2 fluid ounces)
maple syrup
1 teaspoon maple extract
(optional)

In a bowl or measuring cup, combine the warm milk and yeast. Let the yeast dissolve and begin to ferment for 10 minutes. Add the eggs and melted butter, whisking them to combine.

Sift the flour over a large mixing bowl and combine it with the sugar and salt. Slowly add the liquid ingredients to the dry ingredients, mixing until a smooth dough forms. Add additional flour as needed so the dough doesn't stick to the sides of the bowl. Cover and proof the dough for 3 hours so it doubles in size.

Roll the dough into a rectangular shape and ¼-inch thick. Evenly spread the softened butter over the surface of the dough, then sprinkle with brown sugar, cinnamon, and bacon. Tightly roll the

dough from the bottom up. Slice the roll to produce 2-inch-thick rounds, placing them in a baking dish with ½-inch spacing. Once the dish is full, press down on the rolls, mushing them together. Cover loosely with plastic wrap or a towel and let rise 30 minutes to 1 hour before baking.

Preheat the oven to 325 degrees F, then bake for 12 to 15 minutes or until golden brown.

For the frosting, cream together the butter and powdered sugar with a hand or stand mixer, blending smooth. While whipping, slowly add the milk, maple syrup, and maple extract if desired to produce a light and fluffy frosting.

Let the cinnamon rolls cool slightly before frosting, and serve.



blackberry thyme old fashioned

Serves 1

4 blackberries
1 teaspoon sugar
⅛ teaspoon fresh thyme
2 dashes orange bitters
1.5 ounces bourbon
1 large ice cube or sphere
1 sprig thyme, for garnish
Orange rind, for garnish

Muddle the blackberries with the sugar, fresh thyme leaves, and bitters, macerating the berries until the sugar fully dissolves.

Place a cocktail strainer over a rocks glass and transfer your berries to it. Pour the bourbon over the berries, using a spoon to press the juices through the strainer into the glass below.

Remove the strainer and place a large ice cube or sphere in the glass. Garnish with a sprig of thyme and an orange rind. Serve immediately.



ducks in a row

PREPARING FOR THE FUTURE
WITH ESTATE PLANNING

WRITTEN BY MARESA GIOVANNINI

You know you should have a proper will drawn up, and you hope that the people you are closest with have made their own arrangements. But who really wants to spend the time, money, and energy thinking about end of life for themselves and their loved ones? It's probably not on the top of your list for ways to spend a free weekend; however, anything you can do in advance will save everyone a lot of (extra) heartache in the long run. Always consult a lawyer for legal advice; in the meantime, we've gathered some basics about planning for the future, starting today.

What Is Estate Planning?

Estate planning, the preparation of documents to assign inheritances and responsibilities due to death or incapacitation, is an often emotional yet necessary process. You might think a signed will should suffice, but depending on how many beneficiaries and assets you have, the business of it all can be quite complicated.

Estate planning documents are designed to protect and support individuals and families in a multitude of ways. While it feels like there will always be time to get paperwork completed, you'll want to sign on the dotted line when you have all your mental faculties and aren't experiencing any medical conditions that compromise decision-making abilities. If you are able to, plan early and make updates when necessary.

What Do I Need?

If you do nothing else, prepare a will. Without one, you hand power of your assets to the courts and they determine how to divvy everything among your heirs, keeping it tied up in probate for longer than it might be otherwise. Adding a trust makes most sense when you have property and other assets that reach a certain value or if just want to create more flexibility and ease for your family. Beyond those basics, consider an advance health care (medical) directive and power of attorney.

You can include plenty of requests and information in your formal package of documents. Among those, consider your preference for any organ donation, memorial services, burial or cremation desires, obituary placement, or



charity contributions. Consider arranging and paying for placement at a cemetery in advance. You can outline many of these conversations in your will. In addition to explaining what you want, think about what your family will need. Compile a document with account numbers, log-ins, and passwords for your household and any casual online accounts you hold such as Facebook or Instagram. (Even if you don't include this with your legal documents, you might arrange and share the location of it with a trusted loved one.)

Where Do I Find Help?

Ready to dip your toe in but not yet ready to put things in writing? A quick online search

for an estate planning checklist can help you get things sorted before visiting an attorney for the next steps.

There are many things in life you can DIY with little risk; estate planning isn't likely one of them. The American Bar Association (understandably and smartly) cautions against using free online forms as the language may be inadmissible in your state courts, improperly executed, or void if not witnessed. (All risk that can be mitigated.) So, work with a lawyer who specializes in estate planning and let them do the heavy lifting. Gather recommendations from friends and family, consult financial advisors, or turn to your local bar association for guidance.

Where there's a will, there's a way. ■

sale away

One of the most overwhelming parts of estate planning can be thinking about all of the stuff. Who wants the heirloom furniture? Could someone use my vehicle? Would a local charity benefit from a donation? If the things beyond family pictures are causing you stress as the participant or beneficiary, consider the option of an estate sale. Hiring the pros to sort, price, and sell can reduce the stress of this step for all parties. Look for local companies or individuals with a good reputation and comparable rates. As the participant, you can outline these requests in your planning paperwork. As a beneficiary, you can hire a team or organize the sale yourself if you prefer to be hands on.

Shopping an estate sale? Be mindful of the situation. It is not a weekend garage sale with too-small baby clothes and too-much Tupperware. Instead, it is often the material representation of someone's entire life, and family members may be present at the sale. Step through the door with that in mind and leave knowing you are giving someone else's favorite things a new happy home.

bright shade

TEN BLOOMING TREES
FOR YOUR GARDEN

WRITTEN BY RONDA SWANEY

We're used to the green shades and textures of evergreens and the seasonal leaf changes of deciduous trees. But blooming trees expand beyond typical green to add a range of colors to your yard. Turn to these ten popular flowering trees to brighten your shade with color.

Dogwood.

Dogwoods produce white or pink blooms in early spring. They thrive near water, either along streams or creeks or in areas with regular rainfall. Height depends on variety and can range from shrub height up to forty feet. Varieties also cover several growing zones. Pacific dogwood thrives from Southern British Columbia to Southern California. Flowering

dogwood thrives mostly in the eastern US in USDA growing zones 5 to 8 but may appear in the wild in Southern Ontario.

Magnolia.

Magnolias sport leathery leaves and large showy flowers in pink, white, or purple. These are among the oldest known flowering plants, with fossil records dating back more than 100 million years. Southern magnolia is a common variety. The saucer magnolia is hardy and can be grown in Canada. Depending on the cultivar, magnolia tree height ranges from fifteen to eighty feet.

Ornamental Cherry.

These trees bloom spectacularly in spring, loaded with copious white and pink blossoms.

This showy display is short-lived, lasting about a month. Spring isn't the only season of interest for these trees; many varieties boast brilliant red and golden leaves in the fall. They grow to twenty to thirty feet and some varieties produce fruit mostly eaten by wildlife. Yoshino, Kwanzan, and weeping cherry trees are popular North American varieties.

Crabapple.

The springtime blooms of crabapples range from deep red to pink to white and last only about four to five weeks. Fruit appears from fall to winter and may be gold, orange, pink, or red. Wildlife feasts on fruits that can also be harvested to make jelly. Mature height depends on variety and may range from ten to



forty feet. Cultivars of this tree can be found throughout North America.

Serviceberry.

Serviceberry trees offer year-round interest with white blossoms in the spring, edible summer fruit, red or gold leaves in the fall, and showy gray bark during winter. These adaptable plants grow well in full sun to partial shade and reach ten to twenty feet tall. They are robust and thrive in most North American growing zones. Downy serviceberry and Canadian serviceberry are popular varieties.

Hawthorn.

Hawthorns are hardy trees, requiring little maintenance once established. They tolerate sun or shade and most soil types. Their springtime white flowers look like apple blossoms, but some varieties have pink to dark-red blooms. Fruits appear in fall and winter and are mostly eaten by wildlife. Most varieties grow no larger than twenty-five feet. Native varieties of this tree are found in both the US and Canada.

Smoke Tree.

These sun-loving trees come with green or purple leaves and produce puffy flowers in the spring, inspiring the name. Flowers may be creamy white, pink, or purple. They offer fall interest with deep-hued red, yellow, or purple leaves. Smoke trees reach ten to fifteen feet at maturity. This adaptable tree tolerates most soil types; it is drought tolerant but can also manage in wet environments. Smoke tree grows well in US and Canadian growing zones 4 to 8.

Oleander.

Oleanders love sun and bloom in the height of summer. Varieties flower with pink, red, yellow, or white blooms. These trees cannot survive in locales with temperatures below 20 degrees Fahrenheit, so they are best suited for the southern US and other temperate zones. These drought-tolerant plants range from ten to twenty feet tall. Oleander is salt tolerant, so they excel in coastal settings. Hardy Pink is a popular pink variety and Algiers is a popular red-bloomed option. (It is also poisonous, so deer will leave it alone.)

Redbud.

Redbuds prefer well-drained soil and partial shade. These trees feature early to mid-spring blooms that last about two to three weeks. Blooms are pink, red, or purple. Most sport green leaves during the summer that turn brilliant orange or red in fall. Redbuds grow between twenty to thirty feet tall and require minimal care once established. Redbuds are native to the eastern US and parts of Ontario. The Eastern redbud is a popular variety.

Crape Myrtle.

Crape myrtles prefer sun and tend to grow best in the southern US. They bloom for months in the height of summer and come in a wide range of both leaf and bloom colors. Leaves range from dark purple that appears almost black to bright green, while flowers may be white, red, salmon, pink, or purple. Crape myrtles provide winter interest with peeling bark that adds texture to a late-season garden. Varieties range from ten to thirty feet tall. Arapaho is a popular variety that blooms red, while Natchez is a popular white-blooming option. ■



attention to detail

When you see those big reveals on design shows, they are always coupled with an emotional response from the homeowner. That reaction is thanks to the sum of countless thoughtful details combined to create a single space. When done right, someone won't have an immediate answer for why they love the space; they will just feel it. The following home designs do fine detail in a big way, and we hope you love every minute of it—even if you're unsure why.





The glamour of Old Hollywood meets modern sophistication in this Venice Beach townhome, designed by Andrea Putman and Christine Thompson of JAC Interiors.

personality pick

A Venice Beach Town House with Verve

You may not be able to tell a book by its cover, but what can a home tell you about its owners? For a JAC Interiors–designed abode, the answer is *a lot*.

“There are some designers . . . who have a real *look*, and people hire them specifically for that,” says interior designer and JAC cofounder, Andrea Putman. “For us, people don’t hire us based on a look. We try to meet the client where they are and get to know them personally and really understand their aesthetic before we even start any design.”

Putman and her cofounder, Christine Thompson, have been working together since 2012. Based in Los Angeles and Palm Desert, California, the duo uses their complementary skill sets to create vibrant spaces that match their clients’ personalities.

When it came to this renovated town house located in Venice Beach, crafting a design with custom character was a breeze. The young homeowners wanted a bold, fresh look that matched their high-energy lifestyle, with a nod to their backgrounds in the entertainment industry.

“They kind of liked the old-style Hollywood glamour . . . and they wanted something that felt more grown-up and more sophisticated than a California coastal look,” explains Putman. “They were very

open to new and fresh ideas. Her one point was she wanted to live with lots of color.”

One of the first elements the designers chose to incorporate is hard to miss: the geometric Arte wallpaper in the living room. Incorporating cheerful hues of burnt coral and terra-cotta, the print helped inform the rest of the renovation.

Throughout the home, Putman and Thompson balanced the modern, clean lines of the furniture with glimpses of vintage glam—like the drapery framing the living room window and sconce lighting in the stairwell and powder room.

The house required very few architectural renovations, providing the designers a convenient canvas to work with and an opportunity to focus on the details. Some elements just needed a little polish to shine.

“We did a face-lift really,” quips Putman. “There wasn’t a lot of remodeling or anything, which we normally do. It was mostly cosmetic because they didn’t need to change that much.”

WRITTEN BY VICTORIA HITTNER / PHOTOGRAPHY BY ANNIE MEISEL







The homeowner had one request for her design team: lots of color. Putman and Thompson understood the assignment, incorporating sunset-bright hues both inside and out. "We took that to heart and found the [geometric] wallpaper first and then the other elements just came on board, like the yellow kitchen tile and some of the lighting," says Putman. Personal pieces from the homeowner's art collection round out the vibrant palette.







In the more private spaces, details make all the difference. There, the designers used wallpaper to play with both print and texture. In the powder room, a black-and-emerald wallpaper mimics paneling, while the primary en suite bathroom features a waterproof vinyl. "It sounds like your grandmother's wallpaper, but it's very cool!" assures Putman. In the bedroom, a black-and-white textured print makes the Restoration Hardware iron bed frame pop.

The existing oak hardwood floors and exposed staircase were two such elements that fit perfectly into the designers' vision. The home also boasts several original skylights and double-height ceilings—which Putman said made the gallery wall in the dining room an obvious choice. The homeowners had specific pieces they wanted to feature and worked closely with the designers to supplement their existing collection with some prints to tie it all together. Putman notes, "All of [the pieces] really reflect who they are as a couple: bright and cheery and fun."

A sculptural light fixture from Arteriors hangs above the dining table, its matte-black finish complemented by the frames of the gallery wall.

Standout features like the bar counter—"the space just called for it," says Putman—and custom, floating shelving unit seamlessly link the shared living spaces. The shelving unit serves a dual purpose, operating as a media console in one space and wine bar for entertaining in the other.

"[A] custom piece doesn't mean it's more expensive or it takes longer," explains Putman. "It just means it's designed for *you* and you have more freedom."

Upstairs, sentimental pieces—like the bedside tables handed down from parents—add to the home's character and contrast nicely with more expected elements like the wrought-iron bed frame and black-and-white, textured wallpaper.

"We work on a lot of freshly remodeled or new homes," explains Putman, "and if you put everything in there that's of the moment and new, then it looks like it's a staged home. So I really like bringing in some sort of history or patina from the client. Or even if it's not from the client, just bringing in something old to give it a little bit of an earthy feel."



One level up, a rooftop dining area pays homage to the couple's love of color and the home's proximity to the beach. "It was basically just a roof that was dusty and gross and they never went up there," says Putman. "There was no lighting, and you felt very exposed. So we wanted to redesign that so it felt like there was a connection to the outside and to the beach and an outdoor way of living."

Low-profile railings maintain an unobstructed view, while pops of yellow tie the space back to the indoor living spaces, echoed in the kitchen's oversized subway tiles and hardware. Sailcloth shades and Edison-bulb string lights keep the space usable day or night.

From entry to rooftop, this townhome is just as high-energy yet sophisticated as Putman asserts its owners are.

"I think it's such an intimate thing when you're working with an interior designer because we're in your personal space," says Putman. "I always tell people it's like picking a therapist or someone who's going to cut your hair: you want to make sure you like them, . . . that you work together." ■

A bold color palette plays nicely with the comparatively sedate white oak floors in this Philadelphia-area home designed by Brittany Hakimfar. A Circa Lighting chandelier makes a statement in the foyer.

black, white & luxe

Cool California Sensibility in Classically Leaning Pennsylvania

That old adage about the “first pancake” being inedible didn’t apply to designer Brittany Hakimfar’s first house, which—thanks to her fervent efforts—looked straight out of the pages of a magazine, even before it graced these actual magazine pages. “This was my husband and my first home,” says Hakimfar, the designer behind Far Studio, which she runs with her husband Benjamin Hakimfar as co-owners and partners. “We bought it when I had a six-month-old girl and I was pregnant with my son, so we knew it had to be something that was family friendly but also really beautiful.”

Before they bought the 1960s Philadelphia-area abode (which they’ve since sold), the couple were living the big city life in Los Angeles. “We moved to Pennsylvania to raise our kids and give them more space to run around,” says Hakimfar. “I had reservations about my kids growing up in LA and my family was in Pennsylvania; we wanted them to have that East Coast upbringing.” But that didn’t mean they couldn’t bring a bit of SoCal’s cool factor along with them. “We try to bring this West Coast eclectic vibe to the East Coast,” says Hakimfar. “Our area is known to be very traditional, with lots of buttoned-up plaid and toile. But with COVID, a lot of younger people are moving out here.”

There was just one problem: the house they purchased wasn’t exactly ready for its turn in the sunny spotlight. “When we moved into this house it was initially done by a builder, and he redid the old house in ways most people would find unappealing, choosing not the nicest finishes, blue paint colors, and giving the wood floors a reddish

tone,” recalls Hakimfar. “The house sat on the market for a while, but I immediately saw potential because the bones were there.”

To give the property an instant upgrade worthy of a La-La Land starlet, they began by stripping all the floors to their white oak finish. “We left them in their natural state, then sealed them with Bona NaturalSeal to protect them and keep their original color.” Then, because Hakimfar loves an airy feel in her interiors, they painted nearly every single wall Decorator’s White by Benjamin Moore. “It makes the home feel more cohesive, and I like things to feel bright and light,” she says. “[The paint color] brightened up the whole space.”

For their cookspace, Hakimfar wanted to create a Pinterest-worthy look. “I had envisioned a really clean white kitchen that had this white subway tile with dark grout; I put it on my vision board and really loved it,” she says. They salvaged the existing cabinets but transformed the room’s appearance by replacing the counters and backsplash, continuing the tile up around the doorway and opposing wall so the

WRITTEN BY KATHRYN O’SHEA-EVANS / PHOTOGRAPHY BY SEAN LITCHFIELD, WWW.SEANLITCHFIELD.COM







TOP: Hakimfar mixed a custom paint color for their dining room. "I wanted it to be moody and dramatic," she says. BOTTOM: Cassina Perriand stools provide extra seating that can be stowed away quickly. OPPOSITE: In Hakimfar's office, painting both the walls and trim in Off Black by Farrow & Ball created a cozy envelope. "That chair was custom made for me in LA and in the style of an original Martin Olson clam chair," she says.





THIS PAGE: Calacatta oro marble from a nearby stoneyard sheathed the kitchen counters and backsplash in grandeur; the Urban Electric Company pendants add a timeless effect. OPPOSITE: Vintage Marcel Breuer chairs add extra charm to the locally made custom breakfast table.

whole room was tiled—a timeless choice that gives the space the aura of a *Downton Abbey*-era scullery. But the designer's favorite part might just be the open shelving made from reclaimed pine wood. "Those were shelves we actually saw on an auction website and purchased for around \$200 prior to even buying the home, and all the sudden we measured and it was a perfect fit—the exact dimensions we needed," says Hakimfar. The farmhouse craze produced a lot of faux, but these open shelves are likely from an actual farm. "In Pennsylvania, a lot of these auctions have older things from barns, so we're guessing it came from something like that." The brackets they came with were tarnished, so they simply spray-painted them black for a fresh look.

The couple also added necessary detail throughout the home with new millwork, which emits a "been here forever" feel. Says Hakimfar, "In little niche areas where we could have easily put furniture or a cabinet, when you do something that is custom designed from wall to wall and floor to ceiling, it adds something furniture can't do." The final result? "Adding all those pieces gave more dimension to the house, taking it away from builder grade to really feeling like home." ■

it's the little things

How Far Studio used tiny touches to transform their house into a layered masterwork.

Smart Art. "My husband loves collecting artwork—he's really passionate about it," says Hakimfar (one treasured piece: a five-foot-tall abstract by Canadian artist Thrush Holmes). "You have to design a home that can continually evolve, so all of the artwork could easily be moved into other spaces every few months when you get the itch to restyle it."

Texture Time. "It's very easy to [move art around] because of neutral fabric furniture and white walls," says the designer. "I like to blend textures rather than patterns, using linen, boucle, and mohair to bring depth rather than specific patterns or bright colors."

Mix Master. "A lot of pieces of furniture are one of a kind," says Hakimfar, such as cane-back Jeanneret chairs in the living room and a Saarinen tulip table by Knoll. "But then we also have a black Ikea rug in the office—it's a great mix of high and low."

In one of designer Sara Barney's longest installs ever, once the building was complete, the designer had one week to outfit the space from bottom to top and make last-minute tweaks while the homeowners were out of town.

subtlety that wows

A Rock Star Home for a Family of Four

Austin, Texas-based designer Sara Barney of BANDD/DESIGN came into this project with a completely blank slate. The homeowners were moving from San Francisco into a new development—which was, at the time, midway through construction—and planned to take none of their belongings with them. And after getting into the habit of moving every few years, the family of four was intent on making this Austin build their first long-term home.

“The husband kept saying—and I still tease him about it to this day—‘I just want to place that *wows*,’” says Barney. “They just really wanted a space that spoke to them as a family and who they were at this point in their lives, more than anything else.”

Per his request, Barney took inspiration from Lenny Kravitz's Brazilian compound, an eclectic space outfitted in murals and bold photography with layers of wood, leather, and colorful patterns throughout. She swapped out various fixtures and finishes during construction to turn the builder-grade property into a true home.

In the dining room, she commissioned a mural on the wall, meant to imitate a wisp of smoke, and opted for built-in bench seating underneath it to make the large space feel a bit cozier.

From there, the decentralized setup called for structural sconces rather than the oft-expected chandelier, and a custom dining table with an extra-special detail: a steel base that incorporates their initials, T and A, topped with a ten-foot live-edge slab of wood. “That

was, to them, to become sort of like a family heirloom,” says Barney. She capped off the area with a NanaWall system for breezy indoor-outdoor living.

Coming from a fairly neutral home, the family was eager to incorporate color into their new space, though Barney was cautious not to go overboard. In the mostly gray-and-white kitchen, she wrapped the island in handmade blue tile and added warmth with custom rattan bar-banquettes, meant to both give the family more places to cuddle up and to reduce overwhelm from the amount of seating as the sight line flows into the open living room.

Anchored by a two-story plastered fireplace, Barney built out the living room around a metallic Bernhardt coffee table. “We wanted something that was conversational and they could sit around and play games if they wanted to,” she says, but at the same time, an unobtrusive piece “that could easily be pushed out of the way if they needed to for hosting or whatever else.”

WRITTEN BY ALISSA SCHULMAN / PHOTOGRAPHY BY MOLLY CULVER PHOTOGRAPHY







accessorizing from scratch

Starting the decorating process with nothing can quickly lead to creative overwhelm. Designer Sara Barney's recommendation is to lean into the vastness. "With art, I show [clients] a ton of selections, and then that helps me narrow in on the type of art that their eye is attracted to," she says. She follows a similar process with accessories, overbuying based on the needs of the space, and seeing how items interact from there.

In general, Barney abides by the rule of three: grouping decorative elements into visually appealing trios. "Start by layering in different ways," she says, combining items with various textures, sizes, and scale atop surfaces and on walls, and pay attention to negative space. "We can only plan so much when it comes to those accessories and details, but until we get in there and start moving things around, it's hard to truly be fully prepared for it." Don't be afraid to get playful in this later stage.

Barney layered additional materials into the design using complementary light fixtures along sight lines. "Lighting is such an easy way to elevate a space without going overboard or even spending a lot of money," she says. The black and bronze metal dining room sconces flow toward to the concrete pendants above the kitchen island, which are neatly tucked behind the natural water buffalo horn lamps in the living room. Varying shapes help to keep the space from feeling too static.







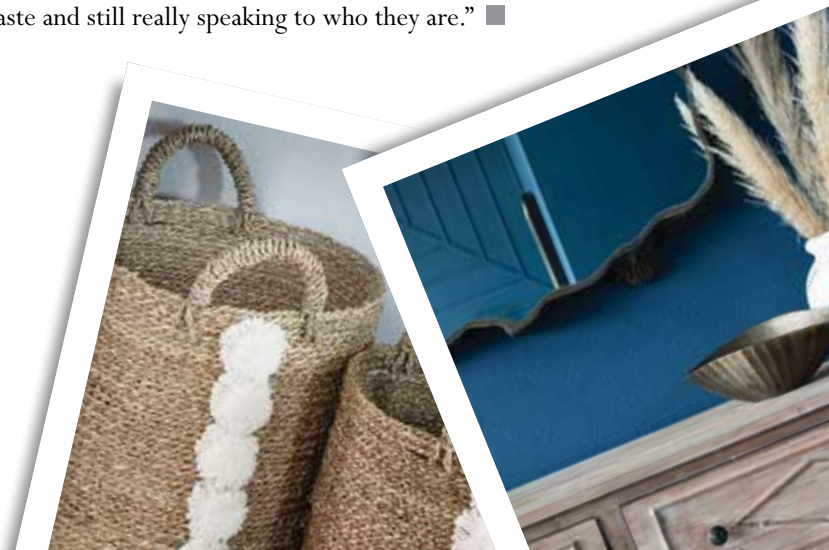
One of the homeowners' top priorities was to have spaces where they could seamlessly move from snuggling up together as a family to welcoming guests into their home, while still showcasing a sense of style. To achieve this effect, Barney invited a sense of comfort to sturdy structures made of wood, metal, and leather by topping seating areas with an overflow of textured pillows and cushions. She slipped in an extra bit of personality with playfully patterned rugs and textured carpets.

She continued the color scheme with a light blue CR Laine sofa and bench seating cushioned by an Aegean-toned Schumacher fabric on either side of the fireplace, flanked by caramel leather, wood, and wicker seating. "Bringing in the color lends to that playfulness and just being a little bit less formal, a little bit more approachable and functional for them," says Barney.

In the primary bedroom, Barney elevated her use of color with a textured accent wall beneath Sherwin-Williams Dignity Blue paint to add architectural interest without disturbing the calm, welcoming environment.

Meanwhile, in the two daughters' rooms, the eight- and six-year-old offered their own design input, where they landed on navy and rainbow schemes, respectively. To create spaces that could grow with the girls, Barney layered swappable elements, such as plush bedding and funky wall tassels. Underfoot, she used rugs on top of wall-to-wall carpeting to add depth and texture to the space, careful to choose thinner rugs so that they'd lay flat and avoid a tripping hazard.

"I think the overall look and feel is that it's warm and inviting and cozy," says Barney. "It's a good example of how you can make a home feel like a home and be beautiful, without being too cataloguey, dark, not enough life and personality in it. It's just really creating that personalized space for them without it leaning too much in their personal taste and still really speaking to who they are." ■



Midcentury elements appear throughout this custom home in Calgary like the walnut screen in the living room that lends visual separation and warmth. The neutral sofa is one of two in the cozy seating area.

designer touches

Deluxe Details in a Custom Calgary Home

In the coveted Britannia neighborhood of Calgary, Alberta, known for sizable lots, mature trees, and proximity to downtown amenities, sits a distinctive dwelling that showcases the success of *carte blanche* when granted to the right designer. In the highly skilled hands of Amanda Hamilton, founder and creative director of Calgary-based Amanda Hamilton Interior Design and online-based Palette Archives, the elements that make a house a home were enhanced when she was entrusted with outfitting this custom residence by RockCreek builders.

“This was one of our first ‘just go with it’ projects,” says Hamilton, who along with her team, had free rein with most of the furniture selections and collaborated with the clients on the rest. “We were really involved in the process.”

The homeowners, a couple with grown children, did their share of renovating and building over the years and developed their own style preferences along the way. “It’s clean-lined, but it still has flourishes and glam,” the designer says about her clients’ essentialist approach and devotion to uncluttered spaces with a twist that stems from a penchant for eccentric embellishments and bold color. Their aesthetic—endearingly dubbed “Midcentury Scandinavian Palm Springs Art Deco Minimalism”—might be a mouthful to say, but it’s easy to understand.

Custom contents deliver the visuals, while sensible layouts support the homeowners’ lifestyle. “We were able to oversee some challenges as far as the context of the overall design,” says Hamilton, who worked mainly with the wife. “She struggled [with] how the long and narrow

living space would interact with the dining space next to the kitchen. We took their personal standpoint and made it work for entertaining with two different seating areas.”

The designer took a hotel-lobby approach with flexible configurations conducive to conversation, like an auxiliary space on one side of the living room with a place to recline after dinner. “It’s more of an intimate space with the linear fireplace,” she says. Now the area that might normally be underutilized can support different activities.

Inspired by the couple’s second home in California, Hamilton introduced a Palm Springs vibe with midcentury touches like reproduction womb chairs covered in a mustard velvet and a custom stool with houndstooth fabric that pulls yellow, green, and blush hues into the room. Houseplants provide some natural softness, while a dramatic slab on the European-style stone fireplace makes a statement. “By blocking out the middle, the eye really sees the flame,” explains Hamilton.

WRITTEN BY JEANINE MATLOW / PHOTOGRAPHY BY JOEL KLASSEN







THIS PAGE: On one side of the long and narrow living room, an intimate sitting area by the European-style stone fireplace offers a quiet gathering spot. The warm palette pairs mustard-colored chairs with green and paler hues in the sophisticated setting that was inspired by the owners' second home in Palm Springs.







OPPOSITE: Distinctive details weave their way into the primary bedroom where a dramatic accent wall features a wallcovering with a feather motif that has a dreamy quality. ABOVE: Contrast is key in the juxtaposition of the black-and-white kitchen with luxe touches of brass and gold that accentuate the main features like the lighting and the cabinetry.

In another part of the living room, clean-lined sofas echo the Scandinavian sensibility and form a second seating area by the dining table and chairs that were positioned near the kitchen in the open-concept home. “We wanted something that really felt artful,” she says. The Japanese-inspired pieces have a sculptural effect with a walnut table paired with blonde chairs that feel light and bright.

Black oak cabinets create a stark contrast to the white quartz countertops in the kitchen, where brass hardware and lighting stand out against the white oak floors and white walls that establish a neutral backdrop. Clear globes keep the sight lines open. “We chose a style that feels more eclectic and vintage with black and gold fittings. It was very intentional to soften the kitchen, and the round globes on the sconces speak the same language,” she says. “It’s quite streamlined with a black-and-white kitchen. The wife loved the glammy pops of gold you see in the light fixtures and we were able to manage all the different styles to feel very cohesive.” Black and gold finishes give a subtle nod to art deco.

Other luxuries that transcend eras include Carrara marble tile floors and double vanities in the primary bath. “You can see those little brass feet that create a light and airy effect with a little bit of that midcentury

vibe,” she says. Ditto for the brass faucets and sconces that blend with other elements to make each one more impactful. “I am very pro mixing metals, like the matte-black hardware on the drawers and the drapery rods that allow the brass to not be overkill,” she adds.

In the primary bedroom, the nightstands also combine wood tones with brass details. The mural with a feather motif creates a dramatic accent wall for the custom upholstered bed covered in deep-charcoal velvet. A faux-leather ottoman, wall-to-wall carpet, and sheer draperies further soften the space. Striking yet restrained details like these deliver a winning combination for a one-of-a-kind style. ■





city of spires

PRAGUE, CZECH REPUBLIC

WRITTEN BY VICTORIA HITTNER

Located in the heart of Europe, Prague thrums with energy both old and new. Dubbed the "City of a Hundred Spires" for its many church towers, Prague is a living exhibit of the region's rich heritage.







OPENING SPREAD: Nestled along the Vltava River, Prague is a city of time-worn wonders and visual delights. **CLOCKWISE FROM LEFT:** Architectural aficionados and history buffs alike have miles to explore, from the Astronomical Clock (pictured here) to Charles Bridge and Prague Castle. A hearty meal is easy to find with local favorites like *halušky* or goulash the perfect complement to a pint. As the birthplace of pilsner, no visit to the Czech Republic is complete without a pour of Pilsner Urquell. Before you leave, stop by one of the city's many markets to take a piece of exceptional craftsmanship home with you.

Founded more than 1,000 years ago, the city is a fascinating blend of Baroque and Gothic architecture, medieval history, modern art, and vibrant nightlife. From the romantic Charles Bridge across the Vltava River to the world's largest castle complex, the city is ideal for romantic sojourners and active adventurers alike.

Navigating the City.

Prague is extremely walkable, but its meandering streets and district numbering system can confuse first-time visitors. The central-most district, Prague 1, encompasses the city's best-known sights. From it, the remaining districts spread out in a spiral-like pattern. Just make sure to pay attention: the numbers don't always align how you'd expect!

Three of the city's most popular neighborhoods—*Malá Strana* ("little quarter"), Old Town (*Staré Město*), and New Town (*Nové Město*)—can be found in Prague 1. The misnomer of New Town—it was founded in the fourteenth century—serves as an apt reminder of the city's longevity.

Must-See Sights.

A trip to Prague would be incomplete without taking a stroll through *Malá Strana*. Take Nerudova Street from St. Nicholas Church up to Prague Castle to catch some of the best views in the city. The large castle complex stretches across 110 acres and served as a residence for some of the most powerful leaders in European history, from the Prague bishops to the Holy Roman Emperors and Habsburgs. Walk along the castle's Golden Lane for a colorful peek into replicas of old shops and tiny housing for castle staff and artists—purportedly including Franz Kafka.

Cross into Old Town using the Charles Bridge for an unparalleled sensory experience. Dozens of Baroque statues line the bridge, which was originally built in 1357.

Vendors and musicians line its edges, while pedestrians stretch to touch some of the statues and plaques for good luck. Look for the plaque of Saint John of Nepomuk—the dog at his feet remains golden from so many "pets" from modern hands!

Once you've crossed the bridge, head toward Old Town Square for a step back in time. Old Town Hall and the Astronomical Clock may be some of the most photographed spots in the city, but for good reason. The medieval clock tower tells time in four different ways and is the oldest of its kind still in operation. Skip the crowds waiting for the hourly show and head inside the tower for a tour of its interior or views of the city.

Head southeast into New Town to visit Wenceslas Square. On your way, make sure to stop by Havel's Market, a street market dating back to the thirteenth century.

For some of the best ways to experience the city and get local stories and recommendations, book a walking or biking tour.

Nibbles and Nosh.

After a long day of walking, Prague offers refreshments for every palate. Enjoy the city's most famous beverage, Pilsner Urquell, in any pub or restaurant in the city. To drink as the locals do, try popular pub *Lokál*.

If you're in the mood for regional fare, comfort food like goulash or *grilované klobásy* (grilled sausage) can be found on almost any corner. Venture outside popular squares for lower prices and more authentic flavors. Struggling to find somewhere to eat for dietary restrictions? Try hidden gem Alriso, with plenty of vegetarian and gluten-free options.

The city is full of international cuisine and flair, too. With so many generations of inhabitants, it's a veritable stew of cultures, people, and stories. Every street reveals surprises, and each visit is sure to be different than the last. ■

travel tips

When to Go:

Summer brings warmth, but it's accompanied by more rain showers and packed streets. Opt for spring or early fall to enjoy mild temperatures, cheaper fares, and fewer tourists.

How to Get There and Get Around:

Prague's main international airport, Václav Havel, is a quick Uber, taxi, or bus ride to the city center. If you're traveling by train, the city is home to two international train stations: Praha Hlavní Nádraží (near Wenceslas Square) and Nádraží Praha-Hološovice (just north of the city center). Public transport is cheap and accessible throughout the city. If you need to travel by car, try Uber or a reputable taxi company like Taxi Praha or FIX TAXI.

Where to Stay:

For proximity to must-see sights, stay in Prague 1 or 2. These districts include popular neighborhoods like Old Town, New Town, and *Malá Strana* (not recommended if you have mobility concerns). Nearby neighborhoods like Vinohrady and Žižkov are trendy, cheaper alternatives.



resources

2022

20 Personality Pick

JAC interiors
Los Angeles and Palm
Desert, California
www.jacinteriors.com

26 Black, White, and Luxe

Far Studio
Bryn Mawr, Pennsylvania
www.farstudio.com

32 Subtlety That Wows

BANDD/DESIGN
Austin, Texas
www.bandddesign.com

38 Designer Touches

Amanda Hamilton Interior Design
Calgary, Alberta
www.amandahamiltondesign.com



light-bulb moment

ILLUMINATING YOUR SPACES WITH SCULPTURAL LIGHTING

Often, light fixtures are viewed as utilitarian. And as long as they cast the right hue and brightness in the appropriate space, they are good to go. But lighting also presents an opportunity to infuse your home with an unexpected layer of artwork. Here, we flip the switch and offer tips and tricks for helping you see the light with sculptural fixtures.

Sculptural does not equate to loud. You can keep these pieces as simple as a globe pendant or as daring as a hat brim chandelier. Lean on classics such as atomic styles paired with midcentury-modern decor or brass-framed milk glass to bring art-deco glam to contemporary black-and-white designs. When you employ sculptural lighting, whether with pendants or sconces, you can keep other design choices simple.

If you are investing in lighting for the first time, start with the dining room. A chandelier over the dinner table should have little else to

compete with, and it is a classic pairing. Statement fixtures help create a focal point in rooms where they might be lacking. In a living room without a wall of windows or a fireplace, for example, sculptural lighting can create a visual landing place and even set the tone for a design. In a bedroom, hang a pair of pendants from the ceiling (one on each side of the bed) to complement a bed frame and encourage upward gaze.

There are seemingly endless options when it comes to lighting, so we recommend narrowing the places you shop and identifying the styles you adore. Because fixtures are usually hardwired, avoid spending the money on just-for-now pieces and wait for the showstopper. A quick search on sites such as Schoolhouse, Design within Reach, Arteriors, Lumens, and even Etsy will help you home in on a light that truly shines. 

well-rounded

USING ARCHES THROUGHOUT YOUR HOME

When it comes to doorways, there aren't an abundance of opportunities to get creative. The transitional features can be narrower, wider, lower, or higher, but that's about as exciting as it gets, right? Enter arches. They lend character to new builds and visually soften homes with hard angles. Although doorways and windows are the most traditional application for this architectural element, it is not the only option. Here, we take a look at how to use arches in your own home design with great success.

The arch, with Roman roots, has seen a lot of modern incarnations. Although there are dozens of ways to top an arch, the most timeless selection is rounded. Rounded arches imbue the appropriate design with classic elegance. Looking to add arches from scratch? You may be able to easily arch a tall doorway or even replace your front door with a rounded version. Built-in niches with an arched design can surprise and delight. Whatever you choose, hire a pro to help ensure the finish will be seamless.

Does your home have existing arches that you love? Give them pride of place with rounded millwork. If renovations from previous owners yielded built-in arches that don't complement the architectural style of your home, consider squaring off the edges. (If the arch is off, it can be like a square peg in a round hole, or, rather, a rounded doorway in a square house.) Then, introduce a more appropriate fit with furniture. Storage cabinets, bookcases, and oversize mirrors are very *of the moment* and easy to find in a style that suits you. 

